



Figure 1: Types of selection

The modified **Toolbox**, shown in Figure 2, comes with 33 tools and two colour swatches. Some of these tools have analogous tasks but they tend to achieve them in different ways.

I have segregated the tools into different categories to help you understand them easily. In this tutorial, we will learn the basic aspects and use of the various tools, and will continue learning about them in more detail in upcoming tutorials (refer to Figure 2).

Drop area

The **Toolbox** starts with a faint 'wilber' logo from the top. This is a drop down area, where you can just drag and drop an image and start editing. It's very handy when working with congested desktops.

Selection tools

The true test of any image-editing program is a comprehensive set of selection tools, which have a wide range of features that go far beyond their stated purpose. You can create stupendous effects only with selection tools. The GIMP comes with quite a few selection tools for various purposes.

- **Rectangle Selection:** This is the first selection tool that you see in the GIMP's **Toolbox**. You can vary its settings to create assorted polygons. You can also use this tool to create rectangles with round edges that come very handy while creating buttons and banners. Just click on the rounded corners in the **Tools** option to create round-cornered rectangles within seconds.

To draw a rectangle, select the tool from the **Toolbox**, and by holding the left mouse button in the **Click** position, drag and expand the figure as much as you want. For the settings, check out Figure 3.

- **Ellipse Selection:** The **Elliptical** selection tool lets you create ellipses and circles in much the same way as the **Rectangular** selection tool. Just select and drag as much as you want to.



Tips: The GIMP provides easy-to-fix options for *Rectangle/Ellipse* selection tools. Notice the square at the corner while you are drawing a rectangle or an ellipse. Just move the pointer to the corner and adjust the selection according to your needs, as shown in Figure 4.

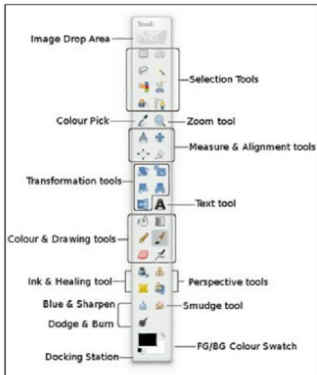


Figure 2: Toolbox demystified

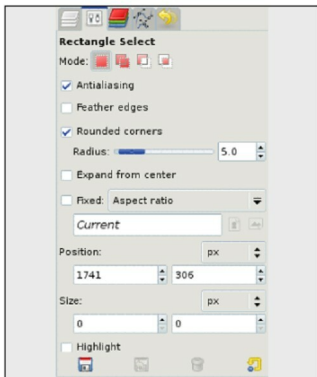


Figure 3: Rectangle Selection settings

- **Free Hand Selection/Lasso:** Free hand selection is a decent alternative to the **Path** tool. With the GIMP 2.6, this tool received many new features like the ability to make selections in multiple clicks, so that you don't have to hold the left click button down in order to complete the selection. Although this tool is generally